

This line modifies `PATH` for all future terminal windows. On macOS Catalina and later versions, the default shell program has changed from Bash to Z Shell, so you'll need to modify `.zshrc` in the home folder instead.

Running Python Programs Without the Command Line

You probably already know how to run programs from whatever launcher your operating system provides. Windows has the Start menu, macOS has the Finder and Dock, and Ubuntu Linux has Dash. Programs will add themselves to these launchers when you install them. You can also double-click a program's icon in a file explorer app (such as File Explorer on Windows, Finder on macOS, and Files on Ubuntu Linux) to run them.

But these methods don't apply to your Python programs. Often, double-clicking a `.py` file will open the Python program in an editor or IDE instead of running it. And if you try running Python directly, you'll just open the Python interactive shell. The most common way of running a Python program is opening it in an IDE and clicking the Run menu option or executing it in the command line. Both methods are tedious if you simply want to launch a Python program.

Instead, you can set up your Python programs to easily run them from your operating system's launcher, just like other applications you've installed. The following sections detail how to do this for your particular operating system.

Running Python Programs on Windows

On Windows, you can run Python programs in a few other ways. Instead of opening a terminal window, you can press WIN-R to open the Run dialog and enter `py C:\path\to\yourScript.py`, as shown in [Figure 2-7](#). The `py.exe` program is installed at `C:\Windows\py.exe`, which is already in the `PATH` environment variable, and the `.exe` file extension is optional when you are running programs.